

MONEY STORIES

While we understand genetics through observation and scientific tests, understanding nurture is best done through stories. That involves being curious about ourselves and those around us and challenging the impact and truth of the money messages, myths and stories we intrinsically believe. That's what we're doing here by discovering your Money Story.

Your Money Story is the collection of your unique money scripts, money messages or money beliefs. It's the stories in your head about whether you believe money is good, bad or okay. It's created from your memories about money—whether that's from your parents, your family and your peers or from the media and society in general. Most importantly, just because you hold them doesn't mean you should believe them or that they're true. That's because, for many of us, our Money Stories are in fact made up of money myths. Just because we've been brought up believing something to be true doesn't make it so. Let me illustrate with one of my favourite stories about money which is an absolute money myth, the modern-day piggy bank.

When we think 'saving money' we often think of the piggy bank. This innocuous object has become synonymous with savings. But if we think more deeply about it, why a pig? I mean, if I think about a pig, I think dirty, muddy, fat, possibly greedy and, of course, bacon. What has any of that got to do with saving money? The truth is absolutely nothing.

In fact, the modern day western piggy bank is the result of a mistake. Nearly 600 years ago, people would store their loose coins at home in common household clay jars. The name of the orange-coloured mud used